

Tao Xu, MSc

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A driven and motivated individual ready for PhD opportunity, graduating with a highest distinction from NUFE and a merit from the University of Edinburgh, with extensive academic and professional experience gained from CITIC, Mazars, Deloitte, NUFE, DKU, and NJU. Possessing exceptional analytical skills, and a proven track record of thriving in pressurised and challenging environments. Diligent and adaptable, with the ability to build and maintain strong working relationships, committed to continuous personal development, and seeking professional challenges to apply my knowledge and transferable skill set, from scientific models to the real world and back to theorisation.

SKILLS & RESEARCH INTERESTS

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|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| ▪ Development Studies | ▪ Political Economy | ▪ Economic Geography |
| ▪ Inequality & Poverty | ▪ Wicked Problem Solving | ▪ Agglomeration & Spillover |
| ▪ International Economics | ▪ Political Settlements Framework | ▪ Regional and Urban Economics |
| ▪ Industrial Policy and Strategy | ▪ New Structural Economics | ▪ Advanced Manufacturing Cluster |

QUALIFICATIONS, AWARDS & PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

M.Sc. Development Studies (International Development, Merit) - The University of Edinburgh, *Nov 2024*

Dissertation Topic: The Road Not Taken? Industrial Policy and Political Settlements in China and Indonesia 1990–2022

Supervisor: Hazel Gray, PhD, Senior Lecturer in African Studies & International Development

Key Modules: Anthropology of International Development; Politics and Theories of International Development; Research Design & Practice; Resource Politics and Development; Interpreting Development Institutions & Practices; Governance, Development and Poverty in Africa; Key Skills in Development Practice

B.Sc. Economics (Commercial Economics, 1st: 91.29/100) - Nanjing University of Finance and Economics, *Jun 2023*

Dissertation Topic: Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters

Supervisor: Yabei Hu, PhD, Professor of Industrial Economics

Key Modules: Microeconomics; Macroeconomics; Econometrics; International Economics; Industrial Organisation; Regional & Urban Economics; Regional Market and Interregional Trade; Platform Economics; Business Economics; Economics of Business Enterprise; Business Design & Innovation; Retailing and Wholesaling Studies; Marketing; Economic History; Procurement & Supply Chain Management

Summer/Winter Schools, Workshops & Seminars

Marxian Political Economy, Advanced/Grad - Wuhan University, Prof Shaodong Zhou, *Jul 2023 - 2024*

Economics of AI, Advanced/Grad - University of Chinese Academy of Sciences, Prof Yongmiao Hong, *Jul 2024*

Research Methodology in Applied Economics, Adv/Grad - Nanjing Agricultural University, Prof Zhigang Xu, *Aug 2023*

Big Data Analytics in Geospatial Sciences, Adv/Grad - Nanjing Normal University, Prof Xueying Zhang, *Aug 2023*

International Business Management - UCLA & University of Saint Joseph, Prof David French, *Jan 2022*

Training, Courses & Certifications

IELTS Academic C1, NCRE Level 2, Excel & Access & Publisher & Canva (IT Literate & Communication)

Stata & EViews & Python & Matlab (Statistics, Quantitative Economics & Econometrics)

NVivo & VOSviewer & CiteSpace (Text Analytics & Bibliometrics)

Health Systems Development, Epidemiology for Public Health - Imperial College London

Epidemiology: The Basic Science of Public Health - The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Microeconomics, The Economics of Health Care Delivery, Comparative Health Systems - University of Pennsylvania

The Korean Economic Development - Yonsei University; Local Economic Development - Erasmus University Rotterdam

Understanding Research Methods - SOAS; Game Theory - UBC and Stanford University
New Structural Economics, Behavioural Economics, Introduction to Logic - Peking University
Advanced Quantitative Social Research, Corporate Finance - Central University of Finance & Economics

Honours & Awards

Jiangsu Provincial Government Scholarship for Overseas Studies	NUFE Principal's Scholarship
Jiangsu Provincial Distinguished Dissertation Award 1st Class	NUFE Honours Graduate
NUFE Distinguished Dissertation Award	NUFE Honours Student *3
NUFE Merit Scholarship for Academic Excellence *6	NUFE Outstanding Student Leader Award
NUFE Merit Scholarship for High Calibre *3	NNU Outstanding Student Award
WHU Outstanding Student Award	WHU Distinguished Paper Award

Professional Memberships

Association for Social Economics (ASE1496) Chinese Society for Technology Economics (IO31402003A)
Chinese Society for Optimisation, Overall Planning & Economic Mathematics (S320004285A)

PUBLICATIONS

- "Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters," with Yabei Hu, *Technology in Society*, 2024, 102583
- "Mismatch and Dysfunction in the Ageing Economy: Internet-Optimised Transformation of the Senior Market," with Yukun Gu, Yibo Wang, Yansong Wang, and Qifei Chen, *Journal of the Jiangsu Association for Commercial Economics*, 2021, 38, 1–9
- "Reshaping Silver-Hair Industry with New Retailing: A SWOT-Based Strategy," *Journal of the China Federation of Logistics*, 2021, 28, 82–85

WORKING PAPERS

- "It Takes Three to Ceilidh: Pension System and Multidimensional Poverty Mitigation in China," with Yansong Wang, and Cheng Yuan, 2024, arXiv 2411.02807, Cornell Tech
- "The Third Way: Reinterpreting the Political Settlements Framework with Structuration Theory," 2024, SocArXiv nmvhq, University Library of Maryland
- "The Road Not Taken? Industrial Policy and Political Settlements in China and Indonesia 1990–2022," 2024
- "The e-CNY as a Cure for SME Financing Obstacles? Based on Modelling and Simulation of Evolutionary Game Dynamics," with Yansong Wang, 2022, ChinaXiv 202207.00004, CAS National Science Library
- "Entrepreneurs or Employees: What Chinese Citizens Encouraged to Become by Social Attitudes?" 2022, MPRA 113212, University Library of Munich
- "Rural Pension System Reform and Social Insurance Participation: 20 Years of Peasant Life in Changing China," with Zhengyi Hu, advised by Dr Yongliang Wu, 2022, arXiv 2204.00785, Cornell Tech
- "Eudemonia and Freedom: Frontiers and Evolution of Labour and Employment Studies in China," with Weiwei Zhu, advised by Ruru Li and Prof Wenwu Zhang, 2021, MPRA 112908, University Library of Munich

WORK IN PROGRESS

- "Economic Growth, Poverty Mitigation, and Social Policy in our Neoliberal Era: A Polanyian Perspective"

REPORTS, PRESENTATIONS & BOOK REVIEWS

- "Good Governance and Political Settlements in Africa," 2024, Edinburgh
- "The Polanyi Critique and Bolivia's Water Wars," 2024, Edinburgh
- "Transformative Communication in Development Organisation: Strategic Engagement and Celebrity Influence," 2024, Edinburgh
- "Turbulence and Order in Economic Development: Economic Transformation in Tanzania and Vietnam by Hazel Gray," 2024, Edinburgh

- "To Rebel, or Not to Rebel? People First Anthropology in Development Praxis," 2024, Edinburgh
- "Just Transition: Free, Prior, and Informed Consent in Resource-Driven Development," 2023, Edinburgh
- "Belt of Productivity, Road to Equality: People First Infrastructure Development in Indonesia," 2023, Edinburgh
- "Having People, Having Heart: Charity, Sustainable Development, and Problems of Dependence in Central Uganda by China Scherz," 2023, Edinburgh
- "Common Prosperity and the Middle Class," *WHU Proceedings of the Summer Institute on Marxian Economics*, 2023, 4, 1–5, Wuhan
- "The Theory of Economic Development by Joseph Schumpeter," 2022, Nanjing
- "Survey on Local Pharmaceutical Specialty Stores: Retail Formats and Elements," with Y Gu, Y Wang, Dapeng Zhu, Wei Li, Zhenyu Zhang, Jingxia Hou, and Yuhan Yang, advised by Prof Jinguo Tao, 2021, Nanjing
- "A Study of History by Arnold Toynbee," 2021, Nanjing
- "Survey on the Ageing Society in Rural Guannan: Consumption, Social Security, and Manufacturing for Silver-Hair Economy," with Y Gu, and Y Wang, advised by Prof Qifei Chen, 2020, Guannan

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Coordinator Assistant (Internship) - Duke Kunshan University (Kunshan, Suzhou) 2023

Student Affairs, Campus Engagement, Arts & Culture, Clubs & Organisations, FYE & SYE Transition

- Planned and managed recruitment & training sessions, policy revisions, evaluation forms, poster-and-flyer designs, and general coordination to ensure the success of FYSAC, Orientation, and Commencement
- Utilised effective communication skills to support student worker interviews, advised on the development and organisation of student groups including FYSAC (14), OL (107), and Commencement Volunteer (97), selected student leaders, FYSAC chairs and OL captains based on resumes and interview reports
- Attended leadership interviews, presentations, and participated in Student Affairs Learning Series (Becoming Socialised in Student Affairs Administration, NASPA Competency, DEI, and Vowels of Supervision)
- Collected and evaluated event data on program for the spring semester, demonstrated creative writing and infographic design skills to prepare slides and materials for meetings and public account promotions
- Identified characteristics of (un)successful events, and proposed improvements to the evaluation system
- Distributed packages for multiple events, and delivered souvenirs to participants involved in campus programs (Scavenger Hunt, MOMENT, and De-Stress Festival)
- Studied exhibition legal documents, drafted licensing and copyright agreements and contracts for the use of photography works and portraits
- Worked with Clubs & Orgs and FYE as a liaison, compiled info on club leaders for marketing, demonstrated coordination skills to support various events such as Involvement Expo, ACG Expo, Arts & Music Festival, and Guest Speaker Lectures (Google China, UNHCR)
- Worked as the Commencement Committee Assistant, oversaw and improved the content of DKU Yearbook 2023, and translated Chancellors' Remarks for the Commencement Brochure and UG Bulletin
- Coordinated graduation-related tasks such as ceremony, banquet, and concert, and wrote letters, intros, and surveys to announce on DKU Commencement website in English and Chinese
- Assisted with social media, summarised policy-and-procedure docs for the establishment of WeChat official account, arranged (sub-)columns, planned content, structure, and time stage of posting articles and tweets
- Executed administrative and logistical tasks including deposit reimbursement (expense reports), storage management, quarterly reflections, minutes of meetings, and email organisation

Advisor Assistant (Internship) - Deloitte (Industrial Park, Suzhou) 2021

Tax & Business Advisory Services, Transfer Pricing, Operations Transformation

- Combined business (executive) overviews, prepared tables of investment, fixed assets, tax credits, inventory, contingencies and other key findings
- Assisted in completion of translation and analysis of reports, translated 3 appendices of transfer pricing drafts and supported analysts to search comparable manufacturers and service providers with TP Catalyst
- Collated Petroliaam Nasional Bhd financial statements and organisation structures of PMCCL, PLSCCL, PCMC

- Supported the team in using RoyaltyStat database to retrieve 517 CAs, reviewed to obtain 33 potential CAs, and select a total of 8 CAs similar to PMCCCL and PL Italy's business for CUP analysis
- Prepared a 42-page report analysing multinational business, intangible assets, and intra-group financing
- Analysed real estate and tax incentives for investment promotion in Changzhou and Wuxi, contacted the Bureau of Commerce and International Investment Centre to advise on industrial layout of labour-intensive foreign-owned enterprises in the Shanghai Metropolitan Area
- Consulted the State Administration of Foreign Exchange in Xiamen to apply accounting treatment regarding a consortium's internal transformation of capital flow by agreement

Audit Assistant (Internship) - Mazars (Industrial Park, Suzhou) 2021

Audit & Assurance, Annual Audit, Reporting & Accounting Operations Advisory Services

- Audited balance sheets and P&L statements of collective assets and state-owned enterprises in Xiangcheng District, tracked and matched the flow of funds and financial statements, produced 31 draft reports
- Verified state-owned assets of Kunshan Hi-Tech Group, independently conducted 7 audit working papers, calculated 9 financial details, reviewed 18 drafts and reported on large transactions

Consultant Assistant (Internship) - CITIC (Kunshan, Suzhou) 2020

Wealth Management, Investment Consultation, Marketing

Executive Assistant & Analyst Associate - HQSW (Suzhou) 2019 - 2022

Information & Consultation, Certification & Accreditation, FDI, International Trade Administration

Research Assistant - Bureau of Finance (Suzhou) 2019

Treasury Management, Fiscal Policy, Government Budget

Secretary Assistant - Administration for Market Regulation (Suzhou) 2018

Quality Supervision, Intellectual Property, Food & Drug Administration, Anti-Monopoly

PROGRAMMES & COMPETITIONS

- Peer Reviewer, Public Library of Science, PLoS ONE, *Nov 2024 - Present*
- Peer Reviewer, Cell Press, Heliyon, *Aug 2024 - Present*
- Peer Advisor, Nanjing University Department of Finance, Social Security and Insurance, *Jun 2023 - Present*
- Peer Advisor, University of Bristol School of Economics, Market Microstructure and Liquidity, *Jan - Oct 2024*
- Co-Investigator and Research Associate, National Social Science Fund of China Programme, Optimisation of Industrial Ecosystems for Advanced Manufacturing Clusters Based on Producer Services, *Oct 2022 - Jun 2024*
- Co-Investigator and Collaborator, National "Culture, Science & Health to Rural China" Programme, Industrial Organisation and Cultural Heritage in Less-Developed Areas, National Excellent Team Award, Provincial Special Team Award, NUFE Best Report Award 1st Class, *Jun 2021 - May 2022*
- Investigator and Leader, NUFE UG Innovative Training Programme, Reshaping Silver-Hair Industry with New Retailing: A Story of China, *May 2020 - Oct 2021*
- Leader, Chinese Society for Optimisation & Economic Mathematics, "MathorCup" Mathematical Contest in Modelling, S Award, *Apr - Jul 2021*
- Volunteer, NUFE Admissions Committee, *Dec 2019 - Jun 2021*
- Investigator and Leader, NUFE UG "Challenge Cup" Academic Competition, Digital Economy, New Retailing & Decent Work, *Nov 2020 - Mar 2021*
- Research Assistant, Jiangsu Administration for Market Regulation Programme, Customer Satisfaction Evaluation: Tertiary Sector in Jiangsu, *May - Nov 2020*

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Language Proficiency: Fluent in English and Mandarin with a good understanding of Wu and Literary Chinese